kissflow

Kissflow App Builder for Claude Code

Setup guide: from installing the plugin to your first app

Kissflow App Builder is a Claude Code plugin that turns an idea or a requirements document into a working Kissflow app: data models, roles, workflows, permissions and pages, with an optional custom React UI. It builds in your account's **Development sandbox**, as you, with your Kissflow permissions. It never changes your production account.

Before you start

YOU NEED	NOTES
Claude Code, installed and signed in	See **claude.com/claude-code**.
Node.js 18 or newer	Check with `node --version`.
A Kissflow Development sandbox	Your account needs a Development sandbox that you can sign in to, and API access must be turned on for the account. Your Kissflow admin can confirm both.
Python 3	Only for native Kissflow pages. The command is `python3` on macOS and Linux, `python` on Windows.
npm, with access to the npm registry	Only for a custom React UI. The first custom UI build sets up its tools once (about 2 minutes).
A supported computer	macOS (Apple silicon or Intel), Linux x64 or Windows x64.

> Behind a proxy or firewall? Allow your Kissflow sandbox address, `github.com` and `release-assets.githubusercontent.com` (for the one-time engine download), and `registry.npmjs.org` (custom UIs only).

1 Install the plugin

In Claude Code, run:

```
/plugin marketplace add kissflow/app-builder-plugin
/plugin install app-builder@kissflow
```

Or, from a terminal: `claude plugin marketplace add kissflow/app-builder-plugin`, then `claude plugin install app-builder@kissflow`.

If `/app-builder:connect` isn't listed in Claude Code afterwards, restart Claude Code.

2 Open a project folder

Give each app its own folder. Create one and start Claude Code inside it:

```
mkdir leave-tracker
cd leave-tracker
claude
```

The plugin keeps this app's design and saved versions in this folder.

3 Connect to your Development sandbox

1. Open your **Development sandbox** in your browser and copy its address from the address bar. Use the Development sandbox, not your production account or a Test sandbox; the plugin refuses both.
2. In Claude Code, run:

   ```
   /app-builder:connect <your Development sandbox address>
   ```

   The first run downloads the build engine for your computer (about 100 MB, once per version).
3. A page opens in your browser. It links to your sandbox's access key settings (**profile picture › My settings › API authentication › Access keys**). Create an access key there, then paste its **key ID** and **secret** into the page. The page checks the key with Kissflow and finishes on its own.
   - Use a key from your own profile. Keys that belong to a service account are refused.
   - Paste the key only into that page, never into the Claude Code chat.
   - If the page doesn't open, use the link printed in Claude Code. It waits up to 15 minutes.
4. Choose the app to build in. A second page lists the apps in the sandbox that you can edit. Pick one, or choose **Start a new app**. You can change it later with `/app-builder:switch-app`.

Run `/app-builder:connect` again at any time to switch to another sandbox.

4 Build your first app

Describe the app in a sentence or two:

```
/app-builder:build-app "A leave request app: employees apply, managers approve, HR sees a monthly summary"
```

Or point it at a requirements document in the folder, such as `/app-builder:build-app "requirements.pdf"`. The plugin then:

1. asks whether you want **native Kissflow pages** or a **custom React UI**;
2. designs the data models, roles, workflows, permissions and pages, checking each part as it goes;
3. does a dry run of every change, then creates the app in your Development sandbox;
4. builds the app's UI.

For a custom React UI, custom UI must be turned on for the app. If it isn't, the plugin gives you a link to the app's settings.

> Want to review the design before anything is created? Use the step-by-step commands instead: `/app-builder:author-brief` → `/app-builder:author-plan` → `/app-builder:author-review` → `/app-builder:author-refine` → `/app-builder:author-preview` → `/app-builder:author-generate`.

Commands

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
`/app-builder:connect`	Connects this folder to your Development sandbox. Run it again to switch sandboxes.
`/app-builder:switch-app`	Switches the app this folder builds in, or starts a new one.
`/app-builder:build-app`	Turns an idea or a requirements document into a complete app, including its UI.
`/app-builder:author-app`	Builds the app from a requirement in one go, without pausing for review.
`/app-builder:author-brief`	Step 1: starts a new build from a requirement and extracts a structured brief.
`/app-builder:author-plan`	Step 2: proposes the complete design: data models, roles, workflows, permissions and pages.
`/app-builder:author-review`	Step 3: opens the plan as an interactive review page, with a clickable prototype for each role.
`/app-builder:author-refine`	Step 4: applies your changes and saves a new version. Repeat as often as you like.
`/app-builder:author-preview`	Step 5: dry run. Shows exactly what will be created, without creating anything.
`/app-builder:author-generate`	Step 6: creates the app in your Development sandbox.
`/app-builder:author-status`	Shows where the current build stands, with its saved versions.
`/app-builder:author-runs`	Lists the builds in this folder and switches between them.
`/app-builder:author-seed`	Loads data into the app: imports reference records from CSV and migrates existing records.
`/app-builder:author-qa`	Tests the built app against every rule in its design: workflow steps, permissions and automations.
`/app-builder:deploy`	Builds the app's custom React UI and puts it in Kissflow.

Keeping it up to date

When a new version is out, update from a terminal, then restart Claude Code:

```
claude plugin marketplace update kissflow
claude plugin update app-builder@kissflow
```

Your data and security

- **Development sandbox only.** Production accounts and Test sandboxes are refused.

- **Built as you.** Everything is created with your own Kissflow permissions.
- **Your access key stays on your computer**, in `~/.kissflow/app-builder/auth/` (`%USERPROFILE%\.kissflow\app-builder\auth\` on Windows), readable only by your user account. It is never written into your project folder. To revoke access, delete the key in Kissflow (My settings › API authentication).
- **What the project folder holds:** `.kf-env` (which sandbox the folder builds in; nothing secret, but don't commit it to source control), `MEMORY.md` and `MEMORY-LOCAL.md` (lessons the agents learn while building), and `runs/` (each app's design and saved versions).
- **The build engine** is downloaded from the plugin's public releases and checked against the published checksums before it runs.
- **Usage data.** The plugin sends no telemetry of its own. Each request it makes to your Kissflow account names the plugin in its User-Agent, with its version, your platform and random ids for this installation, workspace and command, so Kissflow can see how the plugin is used from its own request logs. Nothing about your apps, requirements or data is added. Set the environment variable `KF_TELEMETRY=0` before starting Claude Code to send only the plugin version and platform.

Troubleshooting

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
"… is a production account" or "… is a Test sandbox"	Run `/app-builder:connect` with your Development sandbox's address, and create the key in that sandbox.
"… did not accept this access key"	Copy both the key ID and the secret again, and check the key hasn't expired. If it still fails, ask your Kissflow admin to confirm API access is turned on for the account.
"This key belongs to a service account"	Create an access key from your own profile.
The browser page didn't open	Open the link printed in Claude Code. The page waits up to 15 minutes.
The engine download or checksum check failed	Run `/app-builder:connect` again. Behind a proxy, allow `github.com` and `release-assets.githubusercontent.com`.
Native pages fail with a Python error	Install Python 3 and check that `python3` (`python` on Windows) runs from a terminal.
The custom UI can't be deployed	Turn on custom UI in the app's settings (`/app-builder:connect` prints the link), then run `/app-builder:switch-app`.
`/app-builder:connect` isn't listed after installing	Restart Claude Code.

Uninstall

```
/plugin uninstall app-builder@kissflow
/plugin marketplace remove kissflow
```

To remove everything from your computer, also delete the `~/.kissflow/app-builder` folder (the engine and your saved key), and delete the access key in Kissflow.